

Project Title: AI SME Digital Growth Advisor

Tagline : "Helping SMEs Discover Their Next Digital Step"

Real Business Problem

Over 95% of Malaysian businesses are SMEs.

Many know they should digitalise or adopt AI, but struggle to answer questions like:

- Where should I start?
- Which investment gives me the biggest impact?
- Am I ready for AI?
- Which tools should I implement first?
- How much will it cost?
- What ROI can I expect?

As a result, many SMEs:

- purchase the wrong tools
- waste money
- implement technology in the wrong sequence
- fail to realise business value

Challenge

Design an AI-powered advisor that can analyse an SME in under **5 minutes** and generate a personalised Digital & AI Transformation Blueprint.

The solution should be practical enough that Exabytes can deploy it as a lead-generation and advisory tool for real customers.

Student Deliverables

Instead of simply generating a response, require teams to build a complete assessment workflow.

Step 1 Business Discovery

Ask approximately five smart questions such as:

- Industry
- Company size
- Number of employees
- Current digital tools
- Biggest business challenge
- Growth objective

Bonus: The AI dynamically asks follow-up questions.

Step 2 Generate a Digital Maturity Score

Example:

Digital Maturity

Website

★★★★★

Cloud

★★☆☆☆

CRM

★★☆☆☆

Marketing

★★★☆☆

Cybersecurity

★★☆☆☆

AI Adoption

★★☆☆☆

Overall Score

46 / 100

Step 3 AI Readiness Score

Evaluate:

- leadership
 - data availability
 - employee skills
 - digital workflow
 - process maturity
-

Step 4 Business Pain Point Analysis

Instead of generic AI output, require evidence-based analysis.

Example

Top 5 problems

- ✓ Too much manual work
 - ✓ No CRM
 - ✓ Customer enquiries handled manually
 - ✓ Marketing not measurable
 - ✓ No internal knowledge management
-

Step 5 Generate an Action Roadmap

Rather than simply recommending products.

Example

Phase 1

Quick Wins

- Business Email
- Website
- Cloud Backup

ROI

2-4 weeks

Phase 2

Productivity

- CRM
- Team Collaboration
- AI Meeting Assistant

ROI

3-6 months

Phase 3

Growth

- AI Sales Assistant
- Marketing Automation
- AI Customer Support

ROI

6-12 months

Here's the exciting part

Instead of recommending products.
students build an **AI Recommendation Engine**.

Example

Problem

No business email



Recommend

Exabytes Email Hosting

Google Workspace

Microsoft 365

Explain WHY.

Problem

No website



Recommend

AI Website Builder

Managed WordPress

Magento

Shopify

depending on business.

Bonus 1 - Challenge

Ask AI to estimate

Potential ROI

Example

Business spends

12 hours/week

answering enquiries.



AI Chatbot



Save

8 hours/week



Estimated annual savings

RM18,000

Bonus 2



Bonus 3

- Generate PDF Proposal
- Exabytes branding
- Business summary
- Digital maturity
- Roadmap
- ROI
- Recommended solutions
- Consultant notes
- This is something a sales consultant could immediately download after a customer completes the assessment.

Even Better

Make it a Sales Tool

After assessment

Customer clicks

I would like a free consultation



Automatically

Create Lead



Assign Salesperson



Attach Assessment Report



Sales already knows:

- business size
 - budget
 - pain points
- recommended solutions

before making the first call.

This is genuinely valuable for Exabytes' sales process.